

The Science and Physiology of Flexibility and Stretching

Implications and Applications in Sport Performance and Health

SECOND EDITION



David Behm

“In this comprehensive textbook, readers will discover a wealth of stretching techniques designed to improve flexibility, sport performance, prevent injuries, and promote overall health. Whether you are an athlete looking to enhance performance or simply aiming to increase your range of motion, Professor Behm’s textbook is a must-have addition to your fitness library.”

Prof. Urs Granacher PhD, University of Freiburg, *Germany*

“Professor Behm shares his profound knowledge and expertise in this book. The body of available evidence is presented using an explicative and practical narrative. An essential read for all those interested in the topic.”

Prof. Rodrigo Ramirez-Campillo PhD, Exercise and Rehabilitation Sciences Institute. School of Physical Therapy. Faculty of Rehabilitation Sciences. Universidad Andres Bello. Santiago, *Chile*

“It is the perfect book to tap into the wisdom of stretching as developed by researchers. By reading this book, you will gain wisdom about the past, present, and imagine the future of stretching”

Prof. Masatoshi Nakamura PhD, Faculty of Rehabilitation Sciences, Nishi Kyushu University, Kanzaki, Saga, *Japan*

“With this work, Prof. Behm provides an encyclopedia of flexibility techniques that illustrates the current scientific knowledge on stretching and related training techniques in the most comprehensive manner. The content of this book served as an important baseline for much ongoing research, including my PhD Thesis.”

Konstantin Warneke PhD, University of Graz, Graz *Austria*



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The Science and Physiology of Flexibility and Stretching

The Science and Physiology of Flexibility and Stretching is the most up-to-date and comprehensive book to cover the underlying physiology and psychology of flexibility enhancing techniques, critically assessing why, when, and how we should stretch, as well as offering a highly illustrated, practical guide to stretching exercises. This fully revised new edition not only updates the present information but adds new chapters on areas that have attracted substantial interest in the past five years such as foam rolling, vibration, global effects of stretching, alternative methods to increase flexibility (e.g., resistance training), and others.

Richly illustrated and including an online resource, *The Science and Physiology of Flexibility and Stretching* provides an important scientific inquiry into stretching as well as other flexibility enhancing techniques (e.g., foam rolling, vibration, resistance training, and others) and an invaluable reference for any strength and conditioning coach or student, personal trainer, sports coach, or exercise scientist.

David Behm is a University Research Professor at Memorial University of Newfoundland. He was a highly competitive athlete, excelling in baseball and ice hockey, and he was drafted into the Canadian Football League (1979). His athletic background led him to seek out an academic career in the areas of applied neuromuscular physiology and sport/exercise science. Dr. Behm has won a number of university, national, and international awards based on his internationally recognized research contributions. At the time of publication, he has published more than 20 book chapters and over 400 peer-reviewed scientific articles, which have been cited more than 35,000 times. He consistently presents his research findings internationally, and his work is often featured in popular fitness and health magazines and online publications.



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